Some sacrifices don't hit you until years later. #sacrificeforfreedom #mindset #sucessjourney

Channel: Greg Lav · Published: Nov 11, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/iAhmXMLuZhI Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Greg Lav shares a painful realization: after missing five consecutive Thanksgivings and Christmases to pursue entrepreneurship, he discovered his family had permanently stopped the traditions he thought he could return to whenever he was ready.

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🦃 The Backstory: Five Years of Missed Holidays 0:00

- Greg had not attended Thanksgiving or Christmas with his family for **five consecutive years** while building his business
- The situation only became emotionally tangible to him after a life change: he now has a son
  - Having a child shifted his perspective on family gatherings and made him want to rebuild those traditions
  - He began actively wanting a "big family gathering" for both Thanksgiving and Christmas

📞 The Phone Call That Changed Everything 0:22

- Feeling ready, Greg called his mother — whom he describes as "the best mother in the whole damn world" — and his siblings to restart the holidays
- He offered several generous options to make it easy for the family:
  - Flying them in to him
  - Traveling to New York himself
  - Renting a house for everyone
- The response from his family was blunt and final:
  - On Thanksgiving: *"Greg, we don't do Thanksgiving anymore. You never came, so we stopped that tradition."*
  - On Christmas Eve (December 24th): same answer — that tradition was also gone
- He is one of only two children in the family

- Because he never showed up, his family created their own separate traditions for those days
- There is no longer a family gathering at all

💔 The Real Cost of Entrepreneurship 0:46

- Greg frames the moment as "a confrontation with the reality of the real sacrifices that entrepreneurship demands"
- His core message is a warning against romanticizing the entrepreneurial path:
  - Some sacrifices feel manageable or even invisible in the moment — skipping a holiday "just this year" — but compound silently over time
  - By the time you are ready to reclaim what you gave up, it may no longer exist to reclaim

    > The hardest part wasn't missing the holidays — it was realizing the door had quietly closed while he was busy building.

- He explicitly states he does not want to portray entrepreneurship as "just fun and nice" — there are genuine, lasting personal costs